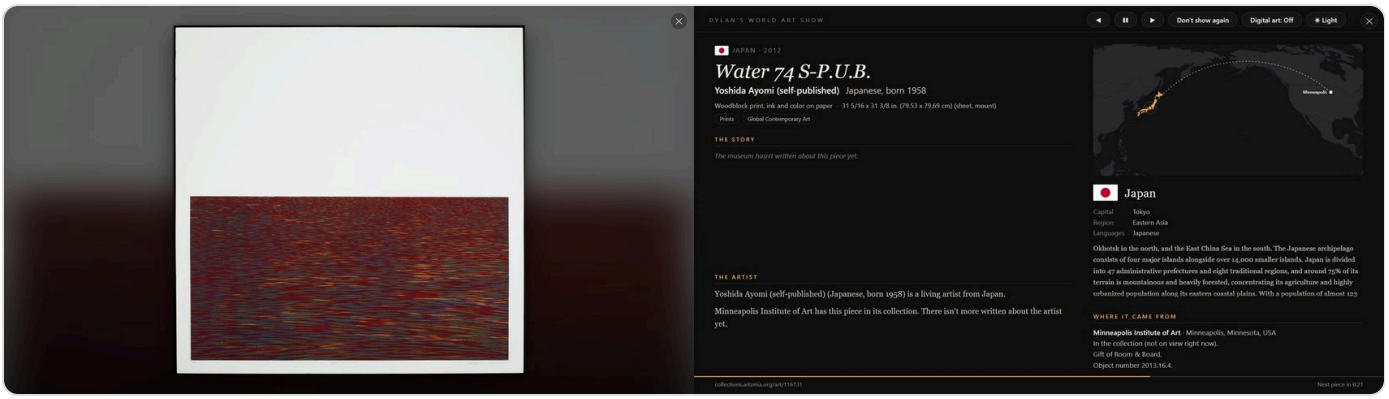
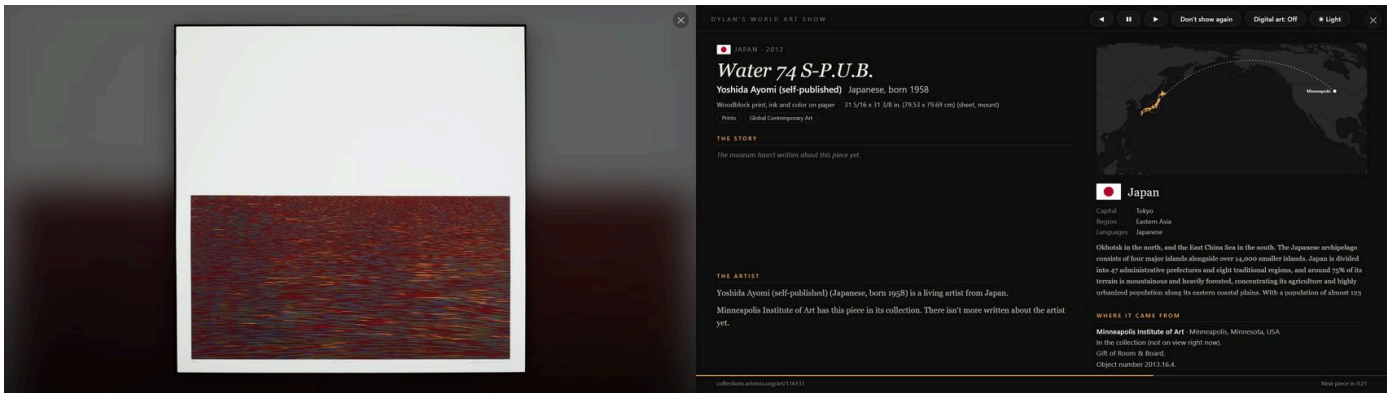
USER'S GUIDE

Dylan's World Art Show

New art by living artists from around the world, a new piece every 60 seconds. On your computer it fills two screens: the art on the left, and its story on the right. On an iPad it's a home-screen app that works in portrait and landscape.





- **Art made by hand or on a computer:** paintings, drawings, watercolors, prints, collages and digital art. No photography, no photos of objects, no AI-made images, no fan art or video game art.
- **New work:** made in 2010 or later, by artists alive today.
- **Travels the world:** each piece is picked by country first. The same artist doesn't come back until hundreds of others have had a turn, and pieces don't repeat until every piece has been shown. On the computer, the show's own window and the Morning and Night Screens share one memory of what's been shown (`seen.txt` in `AppData\Local\WorldArtShow`).
- **New art every day:** DeviantArt's newest staff picks and their artists' new work arrive daily, shown when Digital art is on. With it off (the usual) you see only the museums' pieces, nothing from DeviantArt.
- **Same frame every time:** each piece is shown whole, never cropped, and the space around it is filled with a soft, blurred copy of the piece.
- **Bottom right (iPad):** the artist, their country, the title and year, and the link to the piece at its source.
- **Always fresh:** GitHub rebuilds the art list every 3 hours, and the show loads the newest list every time it opens.

The show: **https://dylaneinsidler.github.io/World-Art-Show/**

On the computer

Right-click `install.ps1` > **Run with PowerShell**. This puts a **World Art Show** shortcut on your Desktop. Double-click it and the show fills both monitors (on one monitor, the two screens stack). Needs Google Chrome or Microsoft Edge.

- **Left screen: the art,** a new piece every minute, whole and as large as it fits.
- **Right screen: everything about it.** The title, artist and year; what it's made of and how big it is; **the story** behind it (the museum's own words, or the artist's own description on DeviantArt); **the artist** (their Wikipedia biography and photo for museum artists, or their DeviantArt profile); **their country** on a world map, with its flag, capital, region, languages and a short introduction; and **where it came**

from: the museum and city (with a line on the map from the artist's country to the museum), or when it was shared on DeviantArt. Long text scrolls slowly by itself while the piece is up. Along the bottom: the link to the piece and the time until the next one.

◀ ❚❚ ▶ on the right screen, or ← **Space** →	previous piece, pause / resume, next piece
☀ **Light** / ☾ **Dark** on the right screen	switches both screens; it's remembered for next time
Digital art: Off / On on the right screen	only the museums' paintings, drawings and prints (Off, the usual: nothing from DeviantArt); or DeviantArt's art too (On); remembered
✕ in the top right corner of either screen, or **Esc**	closes both screens

The screens stay on for up to 4 hours while it's open. It runs from a copy in `AppData\Local\WorldArtShow\app` that `start.ps1` refreshes from this folder on every start, so edit the files here, not the copy. The two screens talk through a tiny web server that `launch.ps1` runs and only this PC can reach (`http://localhost:47233`); it also looks up DeviantArt pieces for the right screen with your DeviantArt key (below), so it never leaves the PC. `country-facts.js` (capitals, regions, languages) is made by `tools/make_country_facts.py`.

On the iPad

1. Open **https://dylaneinsidler.github.io/World-Art-Show/** in Safari.
2. Tap the **Share** button > **Add to Home Screen** > **Add**.
3. Open **World Art Show** from the home screen. It runs full screen and keeps the screen awake. Held sideways it shows landscape pieces; held upright, portrait pieces (near-square pieces show both ways). Turn it and a piece that no longer fits is replaced.

Swipe left for the next piece, swipe right to go back, tap to pause.

On both: tap or click the link under a piece to open its page at the museum or on DeviantArt. While the show is minimized, covered or in the background, it waits, so each piece gets its full minute on screen.

Where the art comes from

- Art Institute of Chicago (USA)
- Minneapolis Institute of Art (USA)
- SMK – National Gallery of Denmark (Denmark)

- DeviantArt: the pieces its staff pick each day (Daily Deviations), plus the last 12 months of new work by those artists (each one's gallery is checked every few days), once a key is set up (below). Judged by each piece's tags: only pieces tagged as painted, drawn or made digitally, and not photographs, AI-made images, fan art, video game or pixel art, crafts, or character-sale posts.

Museum artists need a recorded birth year, no recorded death, and a birth year of 1925 or later. Museums can take years to record a death, so each one is also checked against Wikidata (matching name and birth year). Pieces whose only picture isn't the artwork itself (a photo of the gallery room) can be listed in `tools/leave_out.txt`.

Setting up DeviantArt

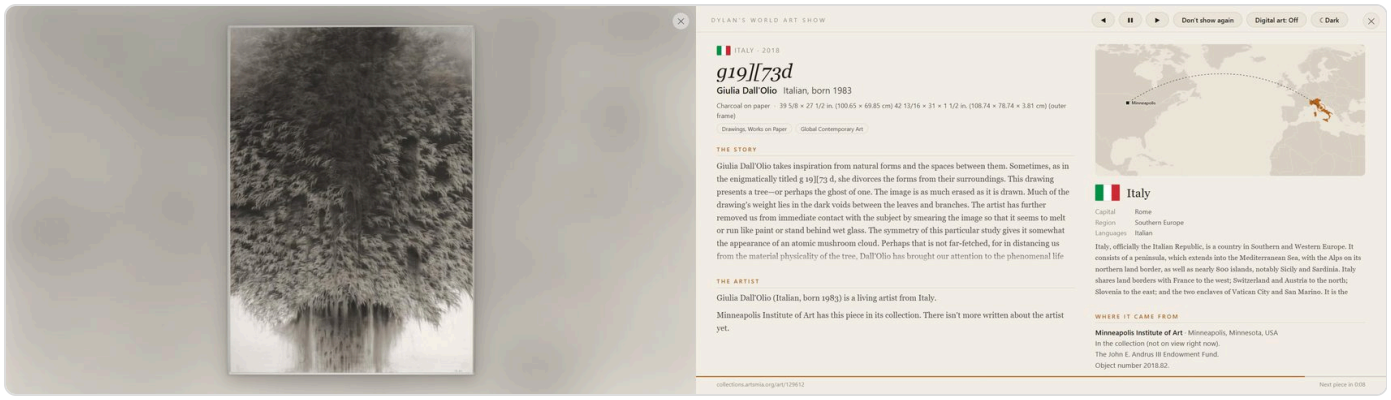
DeviantArt needs a free developer key, and it blocks requests from GitHub's servers, so the PC collects its picks and sends them up:

1. Sign in at deviantart.com (free account), then go to deviantart.com/developers > **Register your Application**.
2. Fill in a title (World Art Show) and a description, set **OAuth2 Grant Type** to *Client Credentials*, put `https://dylaneinsidler.github.io/World-Art-Show/` in the redirect and original URL whitelists, agree to the terms and save.
3. Run `install.ps1` (if you haven't), then open `%LOCALAPPDATA%\WorldArtShow\deviantart-key.txt` in Notepad, replace the two "paste ..." parts with your **client_id** and **client_secret**, and save.

From then on the PC collects DeviantArt's newest picks when the show opens (at most every 6 hours) and once a day at 9 AM (or as soon as the PC is on after that), and sends them to GitHub, which adds them to the show. What it did is logged in `%LOCALAPPDATA%\WorldArtShow\deviantart.log`.

> If something on the screen ever looks wrong, ask Claude about this app by name: everything it needs to know is in the app's folder, *Dylan's World Art Show*.

The screens



Light

What changed lately

> **2.13 (November 5, 2026)**
>
> Dylan: "it's displaying digital art from DeviantArt even when it's toggled off."
>
> - **Digital art Off means nothing from DeviantArt again.** Since 2.12, Off still let in DeviantArt pieces whose tags said they were painted or drawn by hand, but those tags can't tell a painting on paper from one made on a tablet, so digital art got through. Now Off shows only the museums' paintings, drawings and prints (about 630 pieces). On still adds DeviantArt's art. With fewer pieces, the ones shown longest ago come round again sooner.

> **2.12 (November 3, 2026)**
>
> Dylan: "I have not been seeing new art really, and I've been seeing a lot of repeats."
>
> - **New art every day, with Digital art still off.** "Off" used to leave out everything from DeviantArt, so the show was only the museums' 614 pieces, which hardly ever change. Now Off means what it says, no digital art: the museums' pieces plus DeviantArt's hand-made paintings, drawings, watercolors and prints (about 5,200 now, judged by each piece's tags, most of them made this year), with more arriving every day. On still adds the digital art.
> - **No more repeats.** Once all of an artist's pieces had been shown, the show could still pick that artist and show one of them again, so after a few weeks most pieces were repeats. Now it only shows pieces it hasn't shown yet; only when every piece has had its turn does the half shown longest ago come round again.
> - **One memory on the PC.** The show's own window, the Morning Screens, the Night Screens and the App Tester each kept their own list of what they'd shown, so each showed again what the others just had. They now share one list (`seen.txt` , kept by the show's server). The iPad keeps its own.
> - **Fewer "workflow failed" emails.** On November 3 GitHub's publishing service failed for a moment (its own server error, nothing wrong with the show). The update now waits two minutes and tries again before giving up.

> **2.11 (October 31, 2026)**
>
> - **Works on one monitor.** With only one monitor, both screens now open side by side on it, each a smaller copy of what it shows on its own monitor, with everything working as usual. With two monitors nothing changes.